

Theme for helpmates

Helpmates are next only in popularity to direct mate problems and are an integral part of international solving and composing competitions. In helpmates black helps white in mating the black king and black commences play. If 'a' and 'b' are black's first and second moves and 'A' and 'B' are those of white then the solution to a H#2 runs thus: 1.a,A 2.b,B mate. Related or matching solutions can be seen in helpmates which are presented either in multi-solutions or in twins. The theme (rather condition) proposed by Germany for helpmates in the 12th World Chess Compositions tournament is as follows.

In a H#3.5-n, a pinned piece is unpinned, makes at least one move and is pinned again. The piece may be pinned in the diagram already or become pinned in the solution before being unpinned and then pinned again. Twins, set play, multi-solution are allowed. All phases must be thematic.

Charles Masson Fox
Aftonbladet 1927



Helpmate in four moves

**Solution : 1.Rb4 Kd6 2.Rxd4+ Kc5
3.Rd6 Kb5+ 4.Rb6+ Bxb6 mate**

It may be seen that the BRb6 gets pinned on the second move unpinned by WK on its second move and

repinned on black's fourth move followed by mate.

Jorge Kapros Jorge Lois
2nd prize, idee & form 1996



Helpmate in 4 moves

a) Diagram b) Kb3<> c5

**a) 1.Sd5 Rxa2 2.Sc3+ Rg2 3.Scb1
Be2 4.Ka2 Bxc4#**

**b) 1.Sb1 Bxc4 2.Sc3+ Bf1 3.Scd5
Re2 4.Kc4 Rc2#**

In the problem for solving below note the cycle of BK arrival and mating squares

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Helpmate in two

Three solutions

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'Annihilation and switchback'

1.Rb2-f2! (2.Rf3 threat: 3.Qd3
1...Nc2 2.Rf4 +2...Ke3 3.Rf3
+3...Kd2 4.Rd3 3...Kd4 4.Qd3
3...Ke4 4.Qd3 1...Nb3 2.Qe2
+2...Kd4 3.Rf4 + 3...Kc3 .Rc4
1...Ke3 2.Ke5 3.Qe2 2.Kd5

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